

# ESSUGGEST Security Policy

*Technical and Behavioral Measures for the Protection of Accounts and Data*

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## 1. Account Security

Accounts are created and authenticated through Firebase Authentication. New accounts must verify their email address via a confirmation link prior to their first login. Posting privileges additionally require verification of ESSU credentials (e.g., Student number, Course, Section, Year, College) submitted through the user's profile.

## 2. Data Protection Measures

- All traffic between the user's browser and ESSUGGEST is encrypted via HTTPS.
- Data at rest is stored and encrypted through Google Cloud's Firestore infrastructure.
- Access to stored data is governed by Firestore Security Rules, which restrict read and write operations to authenticated and authorized accounts only.

## 3. Monitoring and Incident Response

Reported content and suspicious activity are reviewed by the moderation team. In the event that a security incident affecting user data is identified, affected students will be notified and the matter addressed as a priority.

## 4. User Responsibilities

- Use a strong, unique password for the ESSUGGEST account.
- Refrain from sharing login credentials with any other individual.
- Log out of shared or public devices after use.
- Report any activity that appears suspicious to [essuggest@gmail.com](mailto:essuggest@gmail.com) without delay.

## 5. Limitations

No online system can guarantee absolute security. ESSUGGEST adheres to current best practices appropriate to a student platform of this scale, and this policy will be revised as those practices evolve.

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